

Here's the full curation for **wall**, anchored to the passage phrase **"a shadow on the wall."**
The full **MCQ-ready master list** is included.

WALL

1. Passage anchor

> "Once, she used nothing more than a cup, a torch, and a shadow on the **wall** to explain a difficult idea about light..."

Passage meaning

wall = a vertical structure forming the side of a room or building

牆 ; **牆壁**

Here, the shadow is projected onto an ordinary classroom wall.

Practice

1. The torch created a shadow on the **wall**.

手電筒在**牆上**形成了一個影子。

2. She drew a diagram on the classroom **wall**.

她在課室**牆上**畫了一幅圖。

Core meanings of WALL

2. wall — vertical side of a room or building

= one of the upright structures forming or enclosing a room or building

牆 ; **牆壁**

Examples

1. There is a clock on the **wall**.

牆上有一個時鐘。

2. The room has white **walls**.

這個房間有白色的**牆壁**。

This is the exact passage sense.

3. wall of a building

= vertical structural part forming the side of a building

****建築物的牆****

Examples

1. The outer ****wall**** needs repair.

外****牆****需要修理。

2. A crack appeared in the ****wall****.

****牆上****出現了一條裂縫。

Boundary / barrier

4. wall — structure built to divide or protect an area

= a solid vertical barrier used to enclose, separate, defend, or protect land or property

****圍牆 ; 牆 ; 屏障****

Examples

1. A high ****wall**** surrounds the garden.

花園四周有一道高****牆****。

2. They built a ****wall**** around the property.

他們在土地四周建了一道****圍牆****。

5. city wall

= defensive wall surrounding a city

****城牆****

Examples

1. Parts of the old ****city wall**** still remain.

舊****城牆****仍有部分保存下來。

2. The town was once protected by a stone ****wall****.

那座城鎮以前由石造****城牆****保護。

Natural vertical surface

6. wall — steep natural face

= a steep or nearly vertical surface of rock, ice, etc.

****峭壁；岩壁；冰壁****

Examples

1. The climbers reached a vertical rock ****wall****.

登山者抵達了一面垂直的****岩壁****。

2. The glacier formed a huge ****wall of ice****.

冰川形成了一道巨大的****冰壁****。

Figurative barrier

7. wall — obstacle preventing communication, progress, or contact

= something that separates people or prevents progress, understanding, or interaction

****隔閡；障礙；屏障****

Examples

1. Lack of trust created a ****wall**** between them.

缺乏信任在他們之間形成了一道****隔閡****。

2. Fear can become a ****wall**** that stops people from trying.

恐懼可能變成阻止人嘗試的****障礙****。

This is a major figurative extension.

8. put up / build a wall between people

= create emotional or social distance

****築起隔閡；建立心理防線****

Examples

1. He ****put up a wall**** whenever the conversation became personal.

每當談話變得私人時，他就會****築起心理防線****。

2. Years of conflict ****built a wall between them****.

多年的衝突在他們之間****形成了隔閡****。

Emotional defensiveness

9. put up walls

= become emotionally guarded and prevent others from getting close

****築起心牆；封閉自己****

Examples

1. After being hurt, she ****put up walls****.

受傷之後，她開始****築起心牆****。

2. It took time for him to lower the ****walls**** he had built around himself.

他花了很久才慢慢放下自己築起的****心理防線****。

Large mass / sheet

10. wall of something

= large, dense, vertical or advancing mass of something

****一大片 / 一道……；像牆一樣的……****

Examples

1. A ****wall of smoke**** filled the street.

一道****濃煙牆****充滿街道。

2. We were hit by a ****wall of heat**** when the door opened.

門一打開，一股像牆一樣的****熱浪****迎面而來。

This is a productive metaphorical construction.

11. wall of water

= large mass or wave of water

****水牆；巨浪****

Examples

1. A **“wall of water”** rushed toward the shore.
一道**“巨浪 / 水牆”**衝向岸邊。
2. The broken pipe sent a **“wall of water”** across the floor.
爆裂的水管讓一大片**“水流”**湧過地面。

12. wall of sound

= dense, powerful mass of sound

“聲牆 ; 強烈而密集的聲音”

Examples

1. The band created a huge **“wall of sound”**.
樂團製造出強烈的**“聲牆效果”**。
2. A **“wall of noise”** came from the stadium.
體育場傳來一大片**“巨大聲浪”**。

Sports

13. wall — line of players blocking a free kick

In football/soccer:

= row of defending players standing together to block a free kick

“人牆”

Examples

1. The defenders formed a **“wall”**.
防守球員排成了**“人牆”**。
2. The shot went over the **“wall”**.
射門越過了**“人牆”**。

Established sports sense.

Anatomy

14. wall — outer or enclosing layer of an organ/body structure

= outer structural layer surrounding a cavity, organ, vessel, etc.

****壁；器官壁****

Examples

1. The stomach ****wall**** contains several layers.

胃****壁****由幾層組織構成。

2. The artery ****wall**** became thicker.

動脈****壁****變厚了。

Established scientific/medical sense.

15. cell wall

= rigid outer layer surrounding certain cells, especially plant, fungal, and bacterial cells

****細胞壁****

Examples

1. Plant cells have a ****cell wall****.

植物細胞有****細胞壁****。

2. The ****cell wall**** provides structural support.

****細胞壁****提供結構支撐。

Computing / social media

16. wall — social-media posting area

Historically and in some platforms:

= profile area where messages or posts are displayed

****動態牆；留言牆****

Examples

1. She posted a message on his ****wall****.

他在他的****動態牆****上發了一則訊息。

2. The photo appeared on my ****wall****.

那張照片出現在我的****動態牆****上。

This use is less universal now, but established.

Finance

17. wall — wall of money / capital

= very large amount of money or investment capital

****大量資金；資金牆****

Examples

1. A ****wall of money**** entered the market.

大量****資金****流入市場。

2. Investors expected a ****wall of capital**** to support prices.

投資者預期大量****資本****會支撐價格。

More figurative and domain-specific.

Fixed expressions

18. hit a wall

A. literally collide with a wall

****撞上牆****

B. figuratively reach a point where progress becomes very difficult or impossible

****碰壁；遇到瓶頸****

Examples

1. The car ****hit a wall****.

那輛車****撞上了牆****。

2. I was making progress, then suddenly ****hit a wall****.

我原本有進展，後來突然****遇到瓶頸****。

Very useful figurative expression.

19. run into a wall

= meet a serious obstacle or resistance

****碰壁；遇到阻力****

Examples

1. The project ****ran into a wall**** during negotiations.

專案在談判期間****遇到重大阻力****。

2. Our attempts to solve the issue ****ran into a wall****.

我們解決問題的嘗試****碰了壁****。

20. go to the wall

= fail financially or be destroyed/defeated

****倒閉；垮掉****

Examples

1. Several small businesses ****went to the wall****.

幾家小企業****倒閉了****。

2. Without support, the company could ****go to the wall****.

沒有支援的話，公司可能會****垮掉****。

Especially British English.

21. drive someone up the wall

= annoy someone extremely

****把某人逼瘋；讓某人非常煩躁****

Examples

1. That constant noise **drives me up the wall**.

那種不停的噪音**快把我逼瘋了**。

2. His lateness **drives her up the wall**.

他老是遲到讓她**非常抓狂**。

Very common idiom.

22. off the wall

A. strange, unusual, or unconventional

古怪的；出人意料的

B. in some contexts, spontaneous / unconventional

Examples

1. That's a pretty **off-the-wall idea**.

那是個相當**古怪的想法**。

2. His sense of humor is completely **off the wall**.

他的幽默感非常**天馬行空 / 古怪**。

23. back against the wall

= be in a very difficult position with few options left

被逼到絕境；走投無路

Examples

1. With his **back against the wall**, he took a risk.

在**被逼到絕境**時，他冒了一次險。

2. The team played well with their **backs against the wall**.

球隊在**無路可退**的情況下反而表現很好。

24. writing on the wall

= clear signs that something bad or unavoidable is going to happen

****不祥徵兆；事情將發生的明顯跡象****

Examples

1. The ****writing was on the wall**** long before the company failed.
公司倒閉前很久，****徵兆就已經很明顯了****。
2. He could see the ****writing on the wall****.
他已經看得出****事情不妙的跡象****。

25. fly on the wall

= unnoticed observer able to watch something private

****暗中旁觀者；不被注意的觀察者****

Most common in:

> ****a fly on the wall****

Examples

1. I'd love to be ****a fly on the wall**** during that meeting.
我真想在那場會議裡當個****不被注意的旁觀者****。
2. The documentary offers a ****fly-on-the-wall**** view of the classroom.
這部紀錄片以****不干預式旁觀視角****呈現課室情況。

26. wall-to-wall

A. covering the entire floor or surface

****鋪滿整個地面的****

B. continuous / everywhere

****到處都是；鋪天蓋地的****

Examples

1. The room has ****wall-to-wall carpeting****.
房間鋪著****滿鋪地毯****。

2. The event received ****wall-to-wall media coverage****.

這場活動獲得媒體****鋪天蓋地的報導****。

Related forms

27. walled

= surrounded or enclosed by a wall

****有圍牆的；被牆圍住的****

Examples

1. They entered a ****walled garden****.

他們進入一座****有圍牆的花園****。

2. The old city is completely ****walled****.

那座古城四周都有****城牆****。

28. walling

= construction of walls or wall-like material

****築牆；牆體工程****

Lower priority.

29. wallpaper

= decorative material applied to walls

****壁紙；牆紙****

Examples

1. They replaced the old ****wallpaper****.

他們更換了舊****壁紙****。

2. The room has patterned ****wallpaper****.

房間貼著有圖案的****牆紙****。

A lexicalized compound rather than a separate sense of bare ****wall****.

Key contrasts

30. wall vs fence

****wall****

= solid barrier, commonly brick, stone, concrete, etc.

****牆 ; 圍牆****

****fence****

= barrier usually made of posts, wire, wood, etc., often with gaps

****柵欄 ; 圍欄****

Compare:

> a brick ****wall****

> 磚牆

> a wooden ****fence****

> 木柵欄

31. wall vs barrier

****barrier****

= anything that blocks movement, access, communication, or progress

****障礙 ; 屏障****

****wall****

= literal structure, but can figuratively function as a barrier

So:

> language barrier

> 語言障礙

is broader than:

> a wall between two people

> 兩人之間的隔閡

32. wall vs partition

****partition****

= interior divider separating spaces

****隔板；間隔牆****

****wall****

= structural or enclosing vertical surface, usually more permanent

33. wall vs screen

****screen****

= surface or partition that blocks, displays, or conceals

****屏風；屏幕；隔板****

A wall is generally more structural and permanent.

34. wall vs shadow in the passage

****wall****

= physical surface receiving the image

****牆壁****

****shadow****

= dark shape formed on that surface because light is blocked

****影子****

So:

> shadow ****on the wall****

means:

****影子出現在牆面上****

not that the wall itself is the shadow.

Meaning map

The central concrete meaning of ****wall**** is:

****a vertical structure forming a boundary or side****

From this develop:

Building

wall

→ ****牆壁****

Enclosure

garden wall

→ ****圍牆****

Defense

city wall

→ ****城牆****

Nature

rock wall

→ ****岩壁****

Figurative barrier

wall between people

→ ****隔閡****

Emotional defense

put up walls

→ ****築起心牆****

Mass

wall of smoke / heat

→ ****一道 / 大片濃煙、熱浪****

Sport

defensive wall

→ ****人牆****

Anatomy

artery wall

→ ****動脈壁****

Idiom

hit a wall

→ ****碰壁 / 遇到瓶頸****

The passage uses the ordinary physical-building sense:

****the vertical classroom surface on which the shadow appears.****

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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wall — room/building structure	構成房間或建築物側面的垂直結構；牆 / 牆壁
wall — boundary/enclosure	用來分隔、包圍或保護地方的實體牆 / 圍牆
city wall	用於防禦並圍繞城市的城牆
wall — natural steep face	陡直的岩石、冰等天然表面；岩壁 / 冰壁
wall — figurative barrier	阻礙溝通、理解、接觸或進展的隔閡 / 屏障
put up walls	在情感上防備別人，不讓人接近；築起心牆
wall of smoke/heat/water	像牆一樣密集、巨大或迎面而來的一大片物質 / 力量
wall — football	足球自由球時防守球員排成的阻擋隊列；人牆
wall — anatomy	器官、血管、細胞等外圍的結構層；壁
cell wall	植物、真菌、細菌等細胞外部的結構性細胞壁
wall — social media	顯示貼文、留言等內容的個人動態牆 / 留言牆
hit a wall	遇到難以突破的障礙或瓶頸；碰壁
run into a wall	遇到強烈阻力、重大障礙
go to the wall	公司、組織等失敗、倒閉
drive someone up the wall	使某人極度煩躁、抓狂
off the wall	古怪、不尋常、出人意料的
back against the wall	處於幾乎沒有選擇的困境；被逼到絕境
writing on the wall	預示壞結果即將發生的明顯徵兆
fly on the wall	能在不被注意的情況下旁觀別人活動的人 / 視角
wall-to-wall	從一面牆延伸到另一面；比喻全面、到處都是
walled	被牆包圍或圍住的

Passage recap

> “...a cup, a torch, and a shadow on the ****wall****...”

Here:

****wall**** = ****a vertical surface forming part of the classroom****

Best Traditional Chinese:

* **牆**

* **牆壁**

Natural contextual translation:

****一個杯子、一支手電筒和牆上的影子。****

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

****wall****

= ****a vertical structure forming the side of a room or building****

****牆；牆壁****

The main polysemy contrasts are:

> classroom ****wall****

> → 牆壁

> city ****wall****

> → 城牆

> a ****wall**** between people

> → 隔閡

> ****hit a wall****

> → 遇到瓶頸 / 碰壁

> football ****wall****

> → 人牆

But in the passage, it is simply the literal ****classroom wall**** receiving the shadow.